PRACTICE 02 · 10-MINUTE

The Pressure *Practice*

Pressure→Self-Assurance

DURATION	WHEN	LEVEL	STEPS
10 minutes	Any time	Beginner	4

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Pressure is the feeling that something needs to be done, and done right, right now. It's the internal push to perform, decide, deliver, or hold things together. Often without anyone asking out loud.

Pressure isn't always about workload. It's about the standards you're trying to meet. The tight jaw. The shallow breath. The sense that slowing down would mean falling behind. This practice is here to help you step out of urgency and remember that care doesn't require pressure.

> *"Everything is happening as it should be."*

A note before you begin. You can't think your way out of pressure. This practice works at the body level. Let the breath and the movement do what your mind can't. Trust what you feel, even if it surprises you.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

- A quiet place to sit
- Something to write with
- Something to track time
- A steady object nearby
- 10 uninterrupted minutes

Optional: Essential oils. Choose one that helps your body slow down.

Lavender
Softens urgency

Bergamot
Eases perfectionism and self-judgment

Frankincense
Grounding when pressure feels tied to responsibility

Clary Sage
Supports release when pressure is hard to put down

PRACTICE OVERVIEW

> Pressure often comes from internal rules. Unspoken standards about how quickly something needs to happen or how much of yourself it requires. This practice names the rule underneath the pressure, then softens the body's response to it.

1	Thought Work	4 min
2	Grounding Breath	3 min
3	Micro-Release	2 min
4	Close	1 min

THE PRACTICE

01 Thought Work

4 MINUTES

Pressure often comes from perfectionism. It convinces the body there's no room to pause until everything is resolved. When you slow down and notice the rule underneath the pressure, the body gets permission to soften without giving up care, quality, or responsibility. You're not opting out. You're choosing your pace.

> Sit comfortably. Hold or rest your hand on the steady object. Take one slow breath. Inhale for 4 counts, hold for 7, release for 8.
>
> **In your journal, answer honestly:**
>
> - What do I feel pressured to do right now?
> - What standard am I trying to meet?
> - Where did this urgency come from?
> - What am I afraid would happen if I slowed down?
>
> **Then ask:**

- What actually needs to happen today?
- What could wait, without harm?

Write simply. This isn't about lowering your standards. It's about removing urgency from care.

02 Grounding Breath

3 MINUTES

Sitting with breath, letting the jaw soften

Pressure tightens the upper body. The shoulders brace. The jaw holds. Breathing slowly and fully sends a direct signal to the nervous system that the threat has passed. You don't need to calm down. Just let the pace change.

Sit or stand comfortably.

Inhale slowly through the nose, feeling the breath move into the ribs. Exhale through the mouth, longer than the inhale.

Repeat for several rounds. Let the shoulders drop. Let the jaw soften.

Nature does not hurry, yet everything is accomplished.

03 Micro-Release

2 MINUTES

Pressure often lives in small, held places. This step releases it with simple, deliberate movement. Notice where effort can be reduced without stopping entirely.

> Gently roll your shoulders. Massage your jaw or neck. Unclench your hands.
>
> Stand up and move slowly and deliberately. Notice every step you take. Notice where effort can be reduced without stopping entirely.

04 Close

1 MINUTE

Place one hand on your heart. If you're holding the steady object, notice its weight for a moment. Choose one statement that feels true right now.

"I can move forward without rushing."

"Care doesn't require pressure."

"I'm allowed to choose my pace."

> Take one slow breath. Then return to your day with slightly more space around you.

PRACTICE COMPLETE

You don't need pressure to do meaningful work.

Today, you stepped out of urgency, even briefly. That matters. Clarity often arrives when speed drops. Return to this practice whenever perfectionism starts tightening your body.

Creating inner balance, one conscious pause at a time.

ENJOY YOUR DAY